

U.S. HISTORY HACK

Unit 5

The Great Depression & the New Deal

Crash · Dust Bowl · Hoover · FDR & the New Deal · 1929–1941

Standards US.39 – US.44

US.39

US.40

US.41

US.42

US.43

US.44

UNIT ROADMAP

Where We Are Headed

Unit 5 • The Great Depression & the New Deal (1929–1941) — Causes, Human Impact, and the Federal Response



Standards build in sequence (US.39 → US.44). Each runs as a full lesson: TN standard • “I Can” • direct instruction • verified primary source • vocabulary • guided + independent practice • TCAP-style check with reveal key.

How This Unit Supports Every Learner

CORE PATH

The grade-level lesson every student does — same TN standard, same rigor, same ceiling.

SUPPORT OPTION

An optional scaffold that lowers a barrier, not the goal. Available to anyone.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Vocabulary, pronunciation, Spanish, and sentence frames for multilingual learners — open to all.

RESPONSE CHOICE

Students show understanding their way: write it · say & record it · diagram & label it. Same target.

PROGRESS CHECK

A quick DOK-2 check and confidence rating that routes the next instructional step.

EXTENSION

An optional deeper challenge (higher DOK). The standard stays the same.

Options are available by design and support access without lowering the learning goal. **Supports work alongside, never in place of, required IEP or 504 accommodations.**

BELL RINGER · HOOK

On October 29, 1929 — "Black Tuesday" — the stock market collapsed, and within a few years one in four American workers had no job. Breadlines, Hoovervilles, and dust storms became the face of a decade-long crisis.

What caused the worst economic collapse in American history — and how far should the federal government go to rescue its people?

TURN & TALK

With a partner, list three things you think caused the Great Depression, and one action you think the government should take when millions of people are out of work. Keep your list; we will return to it at the end of the unit.

STANDARD

US.39

Causes of the Great Depression

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the causes of the Great Depression, including: bank failures, buying on margin, crash of the stock market, excess consumerism, high tariffs, laissez-faire politics, overextension of credit, overproduction in agriculture & manufacturing, rising unemployment.

I CAN

I can analyze the causes of the Great Depression, including bank failures, buying on margin, the stock market crash, overproduction, high tariffs, laissez-faire politics, and rising unemployment.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

Unit 4 What era did we just finish, and how did it end?

2

Unit Hook What is the big question of Unit 5?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What 1929 event is often used to mark the start of the Great Depression?

✓ **ANSWER**

The stock market crash of October 1929, especially 'Black Tuesday' on October 29.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

On October 29, 1929, a single day now called 'Black Tuesday,' the New York Stock Exchange lost billions of dollars as panicked investors dumped more than sixteen million shares, wiping out fortunes in a matter of hours.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How could a stock market that had been setting record highs suddenly trigger the worst economic collapse in American history?

Bank Failures and the Banking Crisis

- Bank runs occurred when panicked depositors withdrew money simultaneously, causing banks to collapse.
- With no FDIC insurance, depositors lost life savings when banks failed.
- Over 9,000 banks failed between 1929-1933, and the cascading effect destroyed confidence, leading to more bank runs.
- Failed banks couldn't make loans, reducing economic activity and contracting the money supply by one-third.

SENTENCE FRAME • LANGUAGE SUPPORT (for every learner)

The Great Depression was caused by _____, _____, and _____, which together collapsed the economy.



Unknown / National Archives (NARA), 1931 [National Archives](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Buying on Margin and Stock Market Crash

- Buying on margin meant purchasing stocks with borrowed money, paying only 10% upfront.
- This created artificial demand that inflated stock prices beyond real value.
- When the market crashed on Black Thursday (October 24, 1929) and Black Tuesday (October 29, 1929), \$30 billion in stock value was lost in the first week.
- Margin calls forced investors to sell, driving prices down further in a devastating spiral.



Unknown / U.S. Government, October 29, 1929 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

Overproduction and Credit Overextension

- Factories could produce more than consumers could buy, while income inequality meant most Americans couldn't afford mass-produced goods.
- Agricultural overproduction drove farm prices down 60% between 1920-1932.
- Meanwhile, Americans borrowed heavily for cars, appliances, and homes.
- When incomes fell, loan defaults triggered bank failures and more defaults in a cascading crisis.

Laissez-Faire Politics and High Tariffs

- Republican administrations believed government shouldn't interfere in the economy, delaying decisive action.
- The Smoot-Hawley Tariff (1930) raised tariffs on thousands of imports, triggering international retaliation.
- Global trade declined 25% between 1929-1932.
- This economic nationalism prevented coordinated international response and worsened the worldwide crisis.

Rising Unemployment

- Unemployment rose from 3.2% in 1929 to 23.6% in 1932, leaving 12-15 million Americans jobless.
- Many remained unemployed for years, not just months.
- The unemployed couldn't purchase goods, reduced tax revenue, and created social problems including family breakdown, homelessness, and malnutrition.
- Each factor reinforced others in a devastating downward spiral.

Key Figure

Herbert Hoover

31st President; in office at the Crash



Underwood & Underwood, 1928
[Library of Congress](#)

- Took office in March 1929, months before the Crash
- Insisted the economy was 'fundamentally sound' as it collapsed
- His limited response set up the 1932 election

STRATEGY Use Hoover here only to establish who was in charge when the causes came due.

Stock Market Crash Newspaper Report

Contextualization

New York Times • October 30, 1929

"STOCKS COLLAPSE IN 16,410,030-SHARE DAY. The most disastrous decline in the biggest and broadest stock market of history rocked the financial district yesterday. Billions of dollars in open market values were wiped out as prices crumbled under the pressure of liquidation of securities which had to be sold at any price."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

On October 24, 1929 (Black Thursday) and October 29 (Black Tuesday), the U.S. stock market collapsed in the most catastrophic financial crash in American history. Stock prices had been inflated by years of speculation and margin buying, and when confidence broke, prices fell 25% in a single week. The crash triggered a cascade of bank failures, business collapses, and mass unemployment that would spiral into the Great Depression — the worst economic crisis in American history, lasting through the 1930s. This New York Times front page captures the initial shock of a financial community that had not believed such a collapse was possible.

ANALYZE

What does this newspaper account reveal about the stock market crash?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? New York Times	WHEN? October 30, 1929	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
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Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Great Depression

Gran Depresión

say: grayt dee-PRESH-un

GD

The worst economic downturn in American history, lasting from 1929 to the early 1940s, characterized by massive unemployment, bank failures, business closures, and widespread poverty.

Stock Market Crash of 1929

Crash del Mercado de Valores de 1929

say: stok MAR-ket krash

SM

The sudden collapse of stock prices in October 1929 ("Black Tuesday"), triggered by speculation, overproduction, and panic selling, which signaled the start of the Great Depression.

Buying on Margin

Comprar con Margen

say: BY-ing on MAR-jin

BO

The practice of purchasing stocks by borrowing money (paying only 10% down), which created a speculative bubble that burst when stock prices fell and investors couldn't repay loans.

Bank Failures

Quiebras Bancarias

say: bank FAYL-yerz

BF

The collapse of thousands of banks during the Great Depression when depositors rushed to withdraw their money (bank runs), causing banks to fail because deposits weren't insured.

Mass Unemployment

Desempleo Masivo

say: mass un-em-PLOY-ment

MU

During the Great Depression, unemployment reached 25% at its peak in 1933, with 15 million Americans out of work, creating widespread poverty and desperation.

Herbert Hoover

Herbert Hoover

say: HUR-bert HOO-ver

HH

The 31st U.S. President (1929-1933) who believed in limited government intervention and "rugged individualism," initially opposing direct federal relief for Depression victims.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Trace economic cause and effect

MODEL PROMPT: How did buying on margin turn a stock dip into a crash?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Investors bought stock with borrowed money. When prices fell, lenders demanded repayment, forcing panic selling that drove prices down further - a downward spiral.

THINK ALOUD

In the section, circle each use of borrowed money (margin, credit, loans).

→ **Now you try:** *With a partner, explain one way this borrowing made the whole economy fragile, citing a line.*

House of Cards — Diagramming the Causes of the Crash

Pairs

15 min

RESPONSE CHOICE write it · say & record it · diagram & label it — *all three demonstrate the same learning target.*

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and the 1929 stock market crash newspaper report, build a cause web starting from 'Great Depression' and branching to at least four causes: the stock market crash and buying on margin, bank failures, overproduction and credit overextension, and laissez-faire policies and high tariffs. For each cause, add one detail explaining how it hurt the economy. Then write a one-sentence claim naming which cause you think mattered most and cite one piece of evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed cause web (4+ causes with a detail each) AND a one-sentence, evidence-based claim about which cause mattered most.

SUPPORT OPTION · EXTENSION

SUPPORT OPTION: Web with the four cause branches pre-labeled and a word bank of details to place. EXTENSION: Write a paragraph arguing whether the crash caused the Depression or simply exposed deeper weaknesses in the 1920s economy, using two pieces of evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-5/us39-causes-great-depression.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

What role did "buying on margin" and overextension of credit play in creating economic instability?

- A** Margin buying had no connection to the crash.
- B** Credit was carefully regulated in the 1920s.
- C** Margin buying inflated stock prices artificially, and when prices fell, margin calls forced panic selling that accelerated the collapse while widespread consumer debt created defaults.
- D** Only wealthy investors bought on margin.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What role did "buying on margin" and overextension of credit play in creating economic instability?

- A** Margin buying had no connection to the crash.
- B** Credit was carefully regulated in the 1920s.
- C** Margin buying inflated stock prices artificially, and when prices fell, margin calls forced panic selling that accelerated the collapse while widespread consumer debt created defaults.
- D** Only wealthy investors bought on margin.

Correct answer: C. **Why:** Buying on margin with only 10% down inflated stock prices beyond real value. When the market declined, margin calls forced investors to sell, accelerating the crash. Consumer credit overextension meant defaults cascaded through the banking system.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Bank Failures and the Banking Crisis
- Buying on Margin and Stock Market Crash
- Overproduction and Credit Overextension
- Laissez-Faire Politics and High Tariffs
- Rising Unemployment

★ **EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Was the Great Depression caused mainly by the stock market crash, or by deeper weaknesses in the 1920s economy? Argue your position with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how at least three different causes worked together to bring on the Great Depression. Which do you think mattered most, and why?

TEACHER DECISION BAND **PROGRESS CHECK** → identify barrier → select support → reteach → recheck → extend

SCAFFOLD FADING Guided → Light → independent on evidence; reintroduce for a new barrier. Required IEP/504 accommodations do not fade unless the authorized team changes them.

STANDARD

US.40

The Dust Bowl

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

SSP.01

Collect sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the causes of the Dust Bowl, and explain the social, geographic, and economic impacts.

I CAN

I can analyze the causes of the Dust Bowl, and explain the social, geographic, and economic impacts.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.39 Name two causes of the Great Depression.

2

US.39 What does it mean to buy stock 'on margin'?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What natural and man-made disaster struck the Southern Plains in the 1930s?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Dust Bowl, huge dust storms caused by drought and over-farming.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the 1930s the skies over the Southern Plains turned black at midday as walls of dust hundreds of miles wide rolled across Oklahoma, Kansas, and Texas, burying farms, choking cattle, and driving families off the land.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

What happens to a region, and its people, when the very soil they depend on lifts up into the sky and blows away?

Causes: Over-farming and Agricultural Practices

- Farmers plowed up native prairie grasses that held soil in place.
- High wheat prices during WWI encouraged extensive farming, and tractors allowed farmers to plow larger areas more quickly.
- Monoculture planting depleted soil nutrients and structure.
- Farmers didn't practice crop rotation or soil conservation, leaving the land vulnerable to erosion.

SENTENCE FRAME · LANGUAGE SUPPORT (for every learner)

The Dust Bowl was caused by _____ and _____, and it forced families to _____.



Arthur Rothstein / FSA (FSA), 1936 [Library of Congress](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Causes: Severe Drought

- Severe drought began in 1931 and lasted through 1939.
- Precipitation dropped 40% below normal levels, and record high temperatures increased evaporation.
- Strong winds picked up loose topsoil from the damaged prairie.
- The drought was part of a natural climate cycle, but human activity made its effects catastrophic.



George E. Marsh, 1935 [NOAA](#)

Social Impacts: Migration and Displacement

- 3.5 million people left Great Plains states as "Dust Bowl refugees." Called "Okies" regardless of origin, over 200,000 migrants moved to California seeking agricultural work via Route 66.
- Migration split families, depopulated rural communities, closed schools and churches, and created social tensions as migrants faced discrimination and hostility in destination areas.

Geographic and Environmental Impacts

- 75% of topsoil was blown away from affected areas.
- "Black blizzards" carried soil as far as Washington D.C., with dust storms reducing visibility to near zero. 100 million acres across Texas, Oklahoma, Kansas, Colorado, and New Mexico were affected.
- Some areas required decades to restore productivity, and the native prairie ecosystem was severely damaged.



Sloan (?) / United States Department of Agriculture, May 13, 1936 [USDA](#)

Economic Impacts

- Wheat production fell 40% in affected areas.
- Cattle died from dust and lack of feed.
- Banks foreclosed on thousands of farms as agricultural income fell 60%.
- Rural businesses dependent on agriculture collapsed.
- Local governments lost tax base as property values plummeted, and economic rebuilding took decades.

Key Figures

Dorothea Lange

FSA documentary photographer (1895-1965)



Rondal Partridge, 1936 [Library of Congress](#)

- Photographed Dust Bowl migrants for the Farm Security Administration
- Made 'Migrant Mother,' the defining image of the era
- Turned government photography into powerful social evidence

STRATEGY Use Lange to show how a photograph becomes a primary source that shapes public understanding.

The Okies

Dust Bowl migrant families



Dorothea Lange, 1936 [Library of Congress](#)

- Fled ruined farms across the Southern Plains
- Migrated west, many to California's Central Valley
- Faced hostility, low wages, and migrant camps

STRATEGY Frame the migration as thousands of individual family decisions driven by drought and debt.

Letter from Kansas Farm Woman

Caroline Henderson • June 1935

Corroboration

"Wearing our shade hats, with handkerchiefs tied over our faces and vaseline in our nostrils, we have been trying to rescue our home from the accumulations of wind-blown dust which penetrates wherever air can go. It is almost a hopeless task, for those gritty, grayish clouds of dust seem never to end. The whole world seems to be one vast dust heap."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

Caroline Henderson was an educated farm woman from Eva, Oklahoma who had homesteaded on the plains in 1907 and chose to stay through the Dust Bowl years while many of her neighbors fled. Her letters to a friend in Maryland, published in The Atlantic Monthly, provided one of the most moving and literary accounts of life during the Dust Bowl — the constant dust, the dying crops, the silence where birds used to sing, and the quiet desperation of farm families trying to hold on. Unlike the 'Okies' who migrated, Henderson represents the thousands of families who refused to abandon their land and somehow survived.

ANALYZE

What does this letter reveal about daily life during the Dust Bowl?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? Caroline Henderson	WHEN? June 1935	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
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Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Dust Bowl

say: *dust boh*

Cuenca de Polvo

DB

A severe drought and ecological disaster in the Great Plains during the 1930s, caused by drought and poor farming practices, creating massive dust storms that destroyed farms and forced migration.

Bank Failures

say: *bank FAYL-yerz*

Quiebras Bancarias

BF

The collapse of thousands of banks during the Great Depression when depositors rushed to withdraw their money (bank runs), causing banks to fail because deposits weren't insured.

Mass Unemployment

say: *mass un-em-PLOY-ment*

Desempleo Masivo

MU

During the Great Depression, unemployment reached 25% at its peak in 1933, with 15 million Americans out of work, creating widespread poverty and desperation.

Okies

say: *OH-keez*

Okies

O

Derogatory term for migrant farmers from Oklahoma, Texas, Arkansas, and Missouri who fled the Dust Bowl to seek work in California, often facing discrimination and poverty.

Great Depression

say: *grayt dee-PRESH-un*

Gran Depresión

GD

The worst economic downturn in American history, lasting from 1929 to the early 1940s, characterized by massive unemployment, bank failures, business closures, and widespread poverty.

Hooverilles

say: *HOO-ver-vilz*

Hooverilles

H

Shantytown settlements of homeless people during the Depression, named mockingly after President Herbert Hoover, who was blamed for the economic crisis.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Connect human action to environmental disaster

MODEL PROMPT: Why was the Dust Bowl a man-made disaster, not just bad weather?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Farmers plowed up the grasses that held the soil, then drought hit. Without roots, the exposed topsoil simply blew away. Human choices plus nature made the catastrophe.

THINK ALOUD

Underline one human cause and one natural cause in the section.

→ **Now you try:** *Decide which cause mattered more and defend it with evidence from the text.*

When the Land Blew Away — Causes and Effects of the Dust Bowl

Pairs

15 min

RESPONSE CHOICE write it · say & record it · diagram & label it — *all three demonstrate the same learning target.*

YOUR TASK

Read the letter from the Kansas farm woman and study the Dust Bowl photographs. Complete a three-part organizer: (1) CAUSES, list human farming practices and natural drought that created the Dust Bowl; (2) SOCIAL EFFECTS, describe migration and the 'Okies'; (3) ECONOMIC/GEOGRAPHIC EFFECTS, note ruined land and lost farms. Include at least two items per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether the Dust Bowl was mainly a natural or a human-made disaster.

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-part organizer (causes, social effects, economic/geographic effects, 2+ each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.

SUPPORT OPTION · EXTENSION

SUPPORT OPTION: Organizer with the three sections pre-labeled and a fact bank to sort.
EXTENSION: Write a paragraph using the farm woman's letter as evidence to argue how much human decisions were to blame for the Dust Bowl.

Companion printable: cornell-notes/unit-5/us40-dust-bowl.pdf

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

What combination of human farming practices and natural weather patterns created the Dust Bowl?

- A** Farmers plowed up native grasses, practiced monoculture without conservation, and severe drought combined with strong winds eroded the exposed topsoil.
- B** The Dust Bowl was entirely caused by natural drought.
- C** Modern farming techniques prevented soil erosion.
- D** The Dust Bowl only affected a small local area.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What combination of human farming practices and natural weather patterns created the Dust Bowl?

- A** Farmers plowed up native grasses, practiced monoculture without conservation, and severe drought combined with strong winds eroded the exposed topsoil. ✓
- B** The Dust Bowl was entirely caused by natural drought.
- C** Modern farming techniques prevented soil erosion.
- D** The Dust Bowl only affected a small local area.

Correct answer: A. Why: The Dust Bowl resulted from human actions (destroying native grasses, over-farming, no conservation) combined with natural drought. Without protective vegetation, severe drought and wind eroded topsoil that had taken centuries to develop.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Causes: Over-farming and Agricultural Practices
- Causes: Severe Drought
- Social Impacts: Migration and Displacement
- Geographic and Environmental Impacts
- Economic Impacts

★ **EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Was the Dust Bowl primarily a natural disaster or a human-made one? Defend your claim with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how both human farming practices and nature combined to cause the Dust Bowl, and describe one major social effect.

TEACHER DECISION BAND **PROGRESS CHECK** → identify barrier → select support → reteach → recheck → extend

SCAFFOLD FADING Guided → Light → independent on evidence; reintroduce for a new barrier. Required IEP/504 accommodations do not fade unless the authorized team changes them.

STANDARD

US.41

Impact of the Great Depression on the American People

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the impact of the Great Depression on the American people, including mass unemployment, migration, and Hooverilles.

I CAN

I can describe the impact of the Great Depression on the American people, including mass unemployment, migration, and Hooverilles.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.40 What was the Dust Bowl?

2

US.40 Who were the 'Okies'?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

About what percentage of American workers were unemployed at the height of the Depression?

✓ **ANSWER**

About 25 percent, roughly one in four workers.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

At the depth of the Great Depression, roughly one in four American workers had no job, breadlines stretched around city blocks, and families who had never asked for help lined up for a bowl of soup.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When a quarter of the country is out of work, how does economic collapse reshape ordinary families, neighborhoods, and the American Dream itself?

Mass Unemployment

- Unemployment peaked at 25% in 1933, with 12-15 million Americans jobless.
- Many remained unemployed for 2-3 years or longer, while youth unemployment reached 50%.
- Effects included psychological damage, health problems, skill deterioration, and loss of self-esteem.
- Families faced role reversal as women and children sometimes became breadwinners while men lost their traditional provider role.

SENTENCE FRAME • LANGUAGE SUPPORT (for every learner)

The Great Depression changed American life by _____, which affected families and communities because _____.



Unknown / National Archives (NARA), c. 1930–1935 [National Archives](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Effects on Families and Communities

- Family stress led to increased divorce and desertion.
- Children left school to work, delayed marriage and family formation.
- Multiple generations lived together to share expenses.
- Families relied on mutual aid, growing gardens, bartering, and help from churches and charities.
- Social isolation from shame and embarrassment caused withdrawal from community life.

Internal Migration

- Americans moved seeking better opportunities: rural to urban, South to North (continuing the Great Migration), and Plains to California.
- People followed family networks to find work, moved with agricultural seasons, and sought jobs at government projects.
- Migrants faced discrimination, competition for scarce jobs, overcrowded housing, and cultural adjustment challenges.

Hoovervilles

- Hoovervilles were makeshift shanty towns built by homeless people using cardboard, tin, and wood scraps.
- Named sarcastically after President Hoover, they appeared on city outskirts, in parks, and under bridges.
- Residents organized self-governance, shared resources, and tried to maintain normal family life despite lacking running water, electricity, and sanitation.
- Some of the largest — such as the one in St. Louis — housed around a thousand residents.

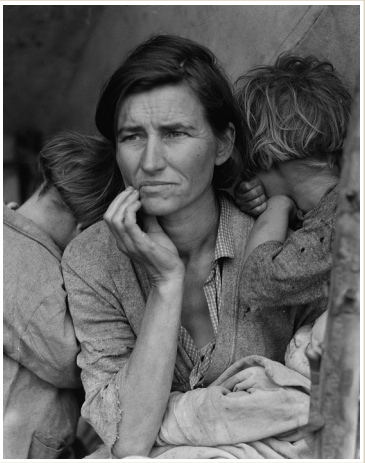
Social Structure Changes

- Many middle-class families fell into poverty while wealth became more concentrated.
- Traditional paths to advancement were disrupted.
- Gender roles shifted as women entered the workforce.
- Community mutual aid increased, and political participation grew.
- The collective trauma affected an entire generation, shaking faith in the American Dream and capitalism.

Key Figure

Depression-Era Families

Ordinary Americans, 1929-1939



Dorothea Lange, February 1936
[Library of Congress](#)

- Endured up to 25% unemployment at the depth of the Depression
- Built Hoovervilles and stood in bread lines
- Migrated in search of any work available

STRATEGY Keep the human scale: one bread line, one Hooverville resident, one family's story stands for millions.

Hooverville Resident Account

Corroboration

Unemployed Factory Worker • 1932

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Arthur Rothstein, 1936 [Library of Congress](#)

"We built our shack out of old packing crates and flattened tin cans. There must be a thousand families living here in this camp by the river. We call it Hooverville after the president who promised us prosperity. Men who used to have good jobs stand in bread lines for hours just to get a bowl of soup. I never thought I'd see Americans living like this."

CONTEXT

As unemployment rose from 3% in 1929 to 25% by 1933, thousands of homeless Americans built improvised shantytown communities from scrap wood, cardboard, and tin on the outskirts of cities and in parks. These communities were called 'Hoovervilles' — a bitterly ironic reference to President Herbert Hoover, who many Americans blamed for the Depression and for refusing to provide direct federal relief to the unemployed. The largest Hooverville in New York City occupied 11 acres in Central Park and housed over a thousand people. By 1932, an estimated two million Americans were homeless, and Hoovervilles had appeared in every major American city.

ANALYZE

What does this account reveal about living conditions during the Depression?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Unemployed Factory Worker	1932	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Mass Unemployment

say: mass un-em-PLOY-ment

Desempleo Masivo

MU

During the Great Depression, unemployment reached 25% at its peak in 1933, with 15 million Americans out of work, creating widespread poverty and desperation.

Hooverilles

say: HOO-ver-vilz

Hooverilles

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Shantytown settlements of homeless people during the Depression, named mockingly after President Herbert Hoover, who was blamed for the economic crisis.

Okies

say: OH-keez

Okies

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Derogatory term for migrant farmers from Oklahoma, Texas, Arkansas, and Missouri who fled the Dust Bowl to seek work in California, often facing discrimination and poverty.

Great Depression

say: grayt dee-PRESH-un

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The worst economic downturn in American history, lasting from 1929 to the early 1940s, characterized by massive unemployment, bank failures, business closures, and widespread poverty.

Dust Bowl

say: dust boh1

Cuenca de Polvo

DB

A severe drought and ecological disaster in the Great Plains during the 1930s, caused by drought and poor farming practices, creating massive dust storms that destroyed farms and forced migration.

Bank Failures

say: bank FAYL-yerz

Quiebras Bancarias

BF

The collapse of thousands of banks during the Great Depression when depositors rushed to withdraw their money (bank runs), causing banks to fail because deposits weren't insured.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Draw evidence of impact from a source

MODEL PROMPT: What does the Hooverville account reveal about daily life in the Depression?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The resident describes shacks, no work, and reliance on scraps. The word 'Hooverville' itself blames the president. The source shows both hardship and anger.

THINK ALOUD

List two concrete details of hardship the source gives.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain to a partner what one detail proves about the Depression's human cost.*

One in Four — Life During the Great Depression

Groups of 3

15 min **RESPONSE CHOICE** write it · say & record it · diagram & label it — *all three demonstrate the same learning target.*

YOUR TASK

Using the Hooverville resident account, the 'Migrant Mother' photograph, and your notes, build a chart showing how the Depression affected ordinary Americans in four areas: employment (mass unemployment), families and communities, internal migration, and housing (Hoovervilles). Add one specific detail for each. End with a one-sentence claim on which group, farmers, urban workers, or the middle class, you think was hit hardest, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-area impact chart (one detail each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about who was hit hardest.

SUPPORT OPTION · EXTENSION

SUPPORT OPTION: Chart with the four areas pre-labeled and a word bank of effects to place.
EXTENSION: Write a paragraph analyzing how the 'Migrant Mother' photograph captures the human cost of the Depression, citing details you can see in the image.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-5/us41-impact-on-people.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did mass unemployment during the Great Depression affect individuals, families, and communities?

- A** Unemployment had limited social effects.
- B** Government programs immediately solved unemployment.
- C** Only industrial workers experienced unemployment.
- D** With 25% unemployment, families faced psychological trauma, role reversals, increased divorce, child labor, and relied on mutual aid while communities experienced population loss and service decline.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did mass unemployment during the Great Depression affect individuals, families, and communities?

- A** Unemployment had limited social effects.
- B** Government programs immediately solved unemployment.
- C** Only industrial workers experienced unemployment.
- D** With 25% unemployment, families faced psychological trauma, role reversals, increased divorce, child labor, and relied on mutual aid while communities experienced population loss and service decline.

Correct answer: D. Why: Mass unemployment devastated American society at every level: individuals lost self-esteem and skills, families faced stress and role reversals, and communities lost population, tax base, and social services as people struggled to survive.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Mass Unemployment
- Effects on Families and Communities
- Internal Migration
- Hoovervilles
- Social Structure Changes

★ **EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Which group, farmers, urban workers, or the middle class, was hit hardest by the Great Depression? Argue your position with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe how the Great Depression changed daily life for ordinary American families. Give at least two specific examples.

TEACHER DECISION BAND **PROGRESS CHECK** → identify barrier → select support → reteach → recheck → extend

SCAFFOLD FADING Guided → Light → independent on evidence; reintroduce for a new barrier. Required IEP/504 accommodations do not fade unless the authorized team changes them.

STANDARD

US.42

Herbert Hoover's Response

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the steps taken by President Herbert Hoover to address the depression, including his: philosophy of "Rugged Individualism", public works projects, the Reconstruction Finance Corporation, and response to the "Bonus Army".

I CAN

I can describe the steps taken by President Herbert Hoover to address the depression, including his philosophy of "Rugged Individualism," public works projects, the Reconstruction Finance Corporation, and response to the "Bonus Army."

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.41 About what fraction of American workers were unemployed at the worst of the Depression?

2

US.41 What were 'Hoovervilles'?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Who was president when the Great Depression began in 1929?

✓ **ANSWER**

Herbert Hoover, the 31st president.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the summer of 1932, thousands of unemployed World War I veterans camped in Washington, D.C., asking for the bonus they had been promised, until the U.S. Army, with tanks and tear gas, drove them out and burned their camp.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When millions are suffering, how much should a president do, and what happens to a leader who believes government should stay out of the way?

Philosophy of "Rugged Individualism"

- Hoover believed individuals should solve their own problems without government help, that federal government shouldn't interfere in economic affairs, and that voluntary cooperation was preferable to government programs.
- He argued direct federal relief violated constitutional principles and would destroy individual initiative and character.
- This philosophy shaped his limited response to the Depression.

SENTENCE FRAME · LANGUAGE SUPPORT (for every learner)

Hoover responded to the Depression by _____, but many Americans blamed him because _____.

Public Works Projects

- Hoover authorized the Boulder Dam (Hoover Dam), employing 5,000 workers at peak.
- He expanded federal building construction, highway programs, and harbor improvements.
- The Emergency Relief and Construction Act (1932) authorized \$2 billion for public works.
- However, these projects were too small in scale, took years to begin, and couldn't significantly impact national unemployment.



Unknown (U.S. Bureau of Reclamation photographer), c. 1932–1934
[National Archives](#)

Reconstruction Finance Corporation (RFC)

- Created in January 1932 with \$2 billion in lending authority, the RFC was based on "trickle-down" theory—help banks and businesses, and benefits would reach workers.
- It provided emergency loans to failing banks, railroads, and large corporations.
- While it helped stabilize some financial institutions, critics saw it as helping wealthy while ignoring common people.
- Its scale was inadequate for the crisis.

Response to the Bonus Army

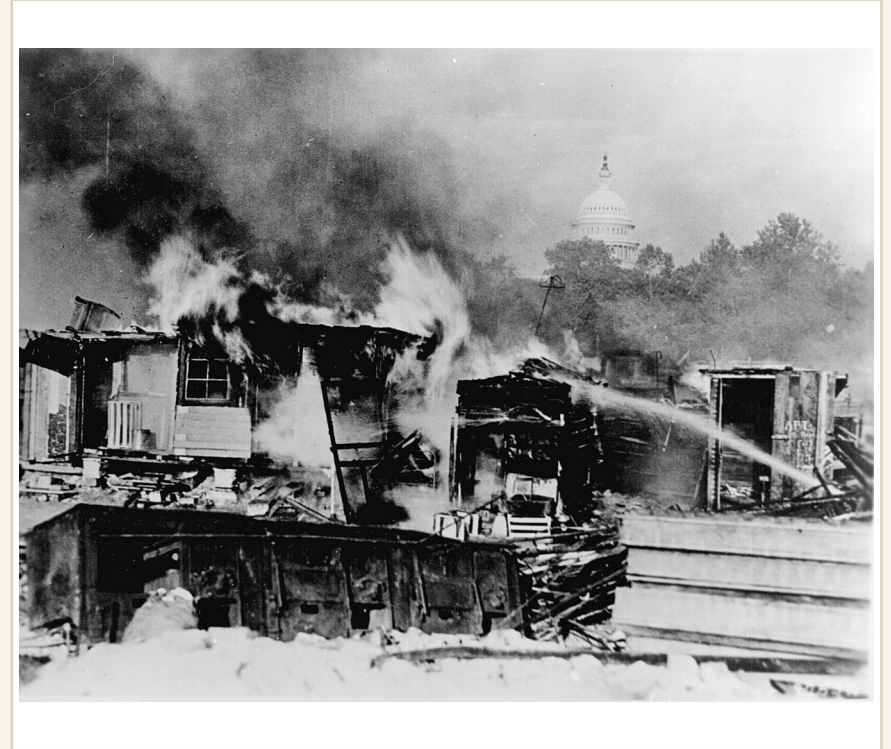
- 17,000 WWI veterans marched to Washington in 1932 demanding early payment of bonus certificates payable in 1945.
- After Congress rejected the bonus bill, veterans camped peacefully.
- When police tried to evict them, violence erupted.
- Hoover ordered the Army to restore order, but General MacArthur exceeded orders, using tanks and tear gas against veterans and their families.



Harris & Ewing / Library of Congress, Prints & Photographs Division (Harris & Ewing Collection), 1932 [Library of Congress](#)

Political Consequences

- The Bonus Army incident severely damaged Hoover's reputation.
- Images of the Army attacking veterans shocked Americans and reinforced perceptions that Hoover didn't care about ordinary people.
- Combined with his philosophy against direct relief, these events contributed heavily to his defeat in the 1932 election, clearing the way for FDR and the New Deal.



Signal Corps Photographer, U.S. Army, 1932 [National Archives](#)

Key Figure

Herbert Hoover

31st President (1929-1933)



Underwood & Underwood, 1928
[Library of Congress](#)

- Championed 'rugged individualism' and voluntary relief
- Created the Reconstruction Finance Corporation (1932)
- Ordered the removal of the Bonus Army - a political disaster

STRATEGY Use Hoover's own words to show he was acting on principle, not doing nothing - then let students judge the results.

Rugged Individualism Speech

President Herbert Hoover • 1928

Argumentation

"During the war we necessarily turned to the Government to solve every difficult economic problem... However justified in time of war, if continued in peacetime it would destroy not only our American system but with it our progress and freedom as well. When the Federal Government undertakes to go into commercial business, it must at once set up the organization and administration of that business."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

Herbert Hoover gave his 'Rugged Individualism' speech during the 1928 presidential campaign, articulating a philosophy that would become both his defining creed and his greatest political liability when the Depression struck. Hoover genuinely believed that the American system of individual enterprise, local voluntary cooperation, and minimal government intervention had made the country great — and that federal relief programs would destroy initiative, undermine character, and create dangerous government dependency. When the Depression hit, his inability to abandon these principles — even as millions suffered — made him appear callous and out of touch. FDR would define himself precisely against Hoover's individualism.

ANALYZE

What was Hoover's view of government involvement in the economy?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Herbert Hoover	WHEN? 1928	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Miller Center, University of Virginia](#)

Word Wall

Herbert Hoover

say: HUR-ber HOO-ver

Herbert Hoover

HH

The 31st U.S. President (1929-1933) who believed in limited government intervention and "rugged individualism," initially opposing direct federal relief for Depression victims.

Bonus Army

say: BOH-nus AR-mee

Ejército del Bono

BA

Veterans who marched on Washington D.C. in 1932 demanding early payment of WWI bonuses. Hoover ordered the military to violently disperse them, damaging his reputation.

Hoovervilles

say: HOO-ver-vilz

Hoovervilles

H

Shantytown settlements of homeless people during the Depression, named mockingly after President Herbert Hoover, who was blamed for the economic crisis.

Rugged Individualism

say: RUG-ed in-dih-VIJ-oo-uh-liz-um

Individualismo Robusto

RI

Hoover's philosophy that individuals should succeed through their own efforts without government handouts, emphasizing self-reliance and private charity over federal aid.

Reconstruction Finance Corporation (RFC)

say: ree-kun-STRUK-shun fy-NANS

Corporacion Financiera de Reconstruccion (RFC)

RF

A federal agency created under Hoover in 1932 that lent money to banks, railroads, and businesses to prevent further collapse.

Mass Unemployment

say: mass un-em-PLOY-ment

Desempleo Masivo

MU

During the Great Depression, unemployment reached 25% at its peak in 1933, with 15 million Americans out of work, creating widespread poverty and desperation.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Evaluate a leader's response

MODEL PROMPT: Was Hoover 'doing nothing,' or acting on a principle?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Hoover's speech shows he believed federal handouts would weaken citizens, so he chose voluntary relief and business loans (the RFC). He acted - but within strict limits.

THINK ALOUD

Find the sentence where Hoover states his belief about the role of government.

→ **Now you try:** *Judge whether his response fit the size of the crisis, and cite one line as proof.*

Rugged Individualism on Trial — Judging Hoover's Response

Pairs

15 min

RESPONSE CHOICE write it · say & record it · diagram & label it — *all three demonstrate the same learning target.*

YOUR TASK

Read Hoover's 'Rugged Individualism' speech excerpt and review the Bonus Army images. Build a two-column chart: WHAT HOOVER DID (rugged individualism philosophy, public works like Hoover Dam, the RFC) and WHY AMERICANS BLAMED HIM (relief seemed too limited, the Bonus Army removal, 'Hooverilles'). List at least two items per column. Then write a one-sentence claim on whether Hoover's response was a real failure or an impossible task for his philosophy.

DELIVERABLE

Completed two-column chart (2+ per column) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about Hoover's response.

SUPPORT OPTION · EXTENSION

SUPPORT OPTION: Chart pre-labeled 'What Hoover Did' and 'Why He Was Blamed' with a word bank to sort. EXTENSION: Write a paragraph arguing whether the forced removal of the Bonus Army was justified, using the images and notes as evidence.

Companion printable: cornell-notes/unit-5/us42-hoover-response.pdf

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did President Hoover's philosophy of "Rugged Individualism" shape his response to the Great Depression?

- A** It led to aggressive government intervention.
- B** His belief that individuals should solve problems without government help led to limited federal response, reliance on voluntary cooperation, and opposition to direct relief programs.
- C** He immediately provided direct payments to unemployed workers.
- D** Rugged individualism had no impact on his policies.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did President Hoover's philosophy of "Rugged Individualism" shape his response to the Great Depression?

- A** It led to aggressive government intervention.
- B** His belief that individuals should solve problems without government help led to limited federal response, reliance on voluntary cooperation, and opposition to direct relief programs. ✓
- C** He immediately provided direct payments to unemployed workers.
- D** Rugged individualism had no impact on his policies.

Correct answer: B. Why: Hoover's rugged individualism philosophy led him to resist direct federal relief, rely on voluntary business cooperation, and delay decisive government action, which proved inadequate for the scale of the economic crisis.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Philosophy of "Rugged Individualism"
- Public Works Projects
- Reconstruction Finance Corporation (RFC)
- Response to the Bonus Army
- Political Consequences

★ **EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Was Hoover's response to the Depression a genuine failure, or was the crisis simply too big for any president using his philosophy to solve? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain Hoover's response to the Depression and why many Americans came to blame him. Give at least two specific examples.

TEACHER DECISION BAND **PROGRESS CHECK** → identify barrier → select support → reteach → recheck → extend

SCAFFOLD FADING Guided → Light → independent on evidence; reintroduce for a new barrier. Required IEP/504 accommodations do not fade unless the authorized team changes them.

STANDARD

US.43

FDR's New Deal Programs

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the impact of the relief, recovery, and reform efforts of President Franklin D. Roosevelt's New Deal programs, including: Agricultural Adjustment Act, Civilian Conservation Corps, Fair Labor Standards Act, FDIC, National Recovery Administration, Securities and Exchange Commission, Social Security, TVA, Works Progress Administration.

I CAN

I can analyze the impact of the relief, recovery, and reform efforts of FDR's New Deal programs, including the AAA, CCC, Fair Labor Standards Act, FDIC, NRA, SEC, Social Security, TVA, and WPA.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.42 What was Hoover's philosophy of 'rugged individualism'?

2

US.42 What happened to the Bonus Army in 1932?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was the name for FDR's programs to fight the Great Depression?

✓ **ANSWER**

The New Deal, a series of relief, recovery, and reform programs.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In his first hundred days in office in 1933, Franklin Roosevelt pushed through a flood of new laws and agencies, an 'alphabet soup' of programs (CCC, WPA, AAA, TVA) meant to put America back to work and never let a collapse like this happen again.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Can bold government action rescue a broken economy, and how much should the federal government be responsible for the welfare of its citizens?

Relief Programs: CCC and WPA

- The Civilian Conservation Corps (CCC, 1933) provided jobs for 250,000 unemployed young men aged 18-25 in rural work camps.
- Over 3 million participated, planting 3 billion trees and building park facilities.
- The Works Progress Administration (WPA, 1935) employed 8.5 million Americans building roads, bridges, schools, and airports.
- WPA also funded arts, writers, theater, and music projects.

SENTENCE FRAME · LANGUAGE SUPPORT (for every learner)

The New Deal used relief, recovery, and reform, for example _____, _____, and _____.



Unknown / National Archives (NARA), c. 1933 [National Archives](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Recovery Programs: AAA and NRA

- The Agricultural Adjustment Act (AAA, 1933) paid farmers to reduce production, raising prices 50% by 1936 and doubling farm income.
- However, it displaced sharecroppers and was declared unconstitutional in 1936.
- The National Recovery Administration (NRA, 1933) created industry codes for wages and hours, guaranteeing workers' right to organize.
- It was also declared unconstitutional in 1935.

Reform Programs: Banking and Securities

- The Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC, 1933) guaranteed bank deposits, eliminating bank runs and restoring confidence.
- The Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC, 1934) regulated stock markets, required company disclosure, and prohibited fraud and manipulation.
- These reforms stabilized the financial system and restored investor confidence.

Reform Programs: Labor and Social Security

- The Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA, 1938) established the first national minimum wage (25 cents/hour), a 44-hour work week dropping to 40 hours by 1940, overtime pay, and prohibited child labor.
- The Social Security Act (1935) created old-age pensions, unemployment insurance, and aid for dependent children—establishing a permanent social safety net that continues today.

Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA)

- TVA (1933) built 16 major dams on the Tennessee River for flood control, electricity generation, and navigation.
- It brought electricity to rural areas, attracted industry with cheap power, and dramatically improved living conditions in one of America's poorest regions.
- TVA demonstrated government's ability to promote comprehensive regional development and continues operating today.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

The Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA), created in 1933, was one of the boldest New Deal programs. It built a series of dams along the Tennessee River to control devastating floods, generate cheap hydroelectric power, and create thousands of jobs, transforming the economy of Tennessee and the entire Tennessee Valley and bringing electricity to rural homes for the first time.

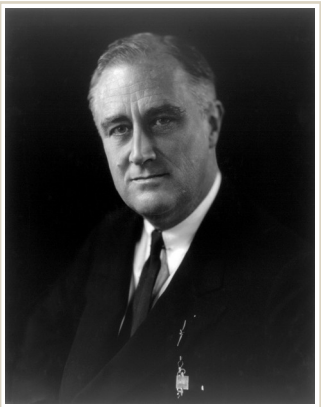


FSA/OWI, 1942 [Library of Congress](#)

Key Figures

Franklin D. Roosevelt

32nd President (1933-1945)



Elias Goldensky, 1933
[Library of Congress](#)

- Launched the New Deal's relief, recovery, and reform programs
- Restored confidence through Fireside Chats and the '100 Days'
- Permanently expanded the federal government's role in the economy

STRATEGY Use FDR to define the 'three Rs' - relief, recovery, reform - as the organizing frame for US.43.

Frances Perkins

Secretary of Labor (1933-1945)



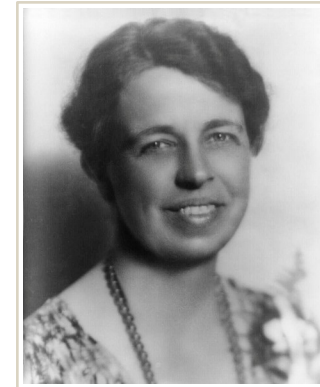
Harris & Ewing, c. 1935
[Library of Congress](#)

- First woman to serve in a U.S. Cabinet
- Chief architect of the Social Security Act (1935)
- Drove labor reforms including the Fair Labor Standards Act

STRATEGY Use Perkins to show the New Deal's lasting reforms had a specific author and a specific agenda.

Eleanor Roosevelt

First Lady & reform advocate (1884-1962)



Unknown, 1933 [Library of Congress](#)

- Championed the National Youth Administration and relief programs
- Advocated for women, youth, and civil rights within the New Deal
- Redefined the role of First Lady as an active reformer

STRATEGY Use Eleanor Roosevelt to widen the New Deal beyond FDR to the coalition that built and defended it.

TVA (Tennessee Valley Authority) Description

Argumentation

Franklin D. Roosevelt • 1933

"It is clear that the Muscle Shoals development is but a small part of the potential public usefulness of the entire Tennessee River. Such use, if envisioned in its entirety, transcends mere power development: it enters the wide fields of flood control, soil erosion, afforestation, elimination from agricultural use of marginal lands, and distribution and diversification of industry."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

The Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA), created in May 1933, was one of the most ambitious and controversial New Deal programs. It transformed the Tennessee River Valley — one of the poorest regions in America — through a network of dams that controlled floods, generated cheap electricity, and enabled navigation. Before the TVA, most of rural Tennessee had no electricity; within a decade, the TVA had brought power to farms and homes throughout the region. Roosevelt proposed the TVA as a model for regional development that could be replicated across the country, but conservatives attacked it as socialism. The TVA remains today the largest public power utility in the United States.

ANALYZE

What was Roosevelt's vision for the Tennessee Valley Authority?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Franklin D. Roosevelt	1933	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Franklin D. Roosevelt (FDR)

say: FRANK-lin ROH-zuh-velt

Franklin D. Roosevelt (FDR)

FD

The 32nd U.S. President (1933-1945) who led America through the Great Depression and World War II, implementing the New Deal and fundamentally expanding the federal government's role.

New Deal

say: noo deel

New Deal

ND

FDR's comprehensive programs to provide relief, recovery, and reform during the Great Depression, fundamentally expanding federal government power and establishing the social safety net.

Civilian Conservation Corps (CCC)

say: sih-VIL-yun kon-ser-VAY-shun kor

Cuerpo Civil de Conservación (CCC)

CC

New Deal program that employed young men in conservation projects, building trails, planting trees, and developing parks, providing jobs for over 3 million young men.

Works Progress Administration (WPA)

say: werks PROG-res ad-min-ih-STRAY-shun

Administración de Progreso de Obras (WPA)

WP

The largest New Deal agency, employing 8.5 million Americans to build roads, bridges, schools, airports, and create art, music, and literature projects.

Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA)

say: ten-eh-SEE VAL-ee aw-THOR-ih-tee

Autoridad del Valle de Tennessee (TVA)

TV

Federal agency created to develop the Tennessee Valley region through hydroelectric dams, flood control, reforestation, and economic development, bringing electricity to rural areas.

Social Security Act (1935)

say: SOH-shul sih-KYOOR-ih-tee

Ley de Seguridad Social (1935)

SS

Landmark New Deal legislation creating a federal system of old-age pensions, unemployment insurance, and aid for disabled and dependent children, forming America's social safety net.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Sort programs by purpose
(relief/recovery/reform)

MODEL PROMPT: How do you tell a relief program from a reform program?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Relief gives immediate help (CCC jobs, WPA work). Recovery restarts the economy (AAA, NRA). Reform prevents the next crisis (FDIC, SEC, Social Security). The GOAL is the test.

THINK ALOUD

Label each program in the section as Relief, Recovery, or Reform.

→ Now you try: *Pick one program and explain which 'R' it is and why, using the text.*

US.43 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Alphabet Soup — Sorting the New Deal's 3 Rs

Groups of 3

15 min **RESPONSE CHOICE** write it · say & record it · diagram & label it — all three demonstrate the same learning target.

YOUR TASK

Read the TVA description and use your notes to build a three-column chart sorting New Deal programs into RELIEF (CCC, WPA), RECOVERY (AAA, NRA), and REFORM (banking regulation and the FDIC, Social Security, the SEC). For each program, write one sentence on what it did. Mark the TVA and note how it combined all three in Tennessee. End with a one-sentence claim on which of the 3 Rs was the most important New Deal legacy.



Harris & Ewing, 1936 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed 3 Rs chart (programs sorted with a one-sentence purpose each)
AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.

SUPPORT OPTION · EXTENSION

SUPPORT OPTION: Chart with the three columns pre-labeled and a card set of programs to sort. EXTENSION: Write a paragraph explaining how the TVA delivered relief, recovery, AND reform to the Tennessee Valley, citing the description.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-5/us43-new-deal-programs.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did the "Three R's" (Relief, Recovery, Reform) organize Roosevelt's approach to ending the Great Depression?

- A** Relief provided immediate help to unemployed (CCC, WPA), Recovery programs restored economic activity (AAA, NRA), and Reform programs fixed underlying problems (FDIC, SEC, Social Security).
- B** FDR used only one approach throughout the New Deal.
- C** The Three R's were unrelated programs.
- D** Roosevelt opposed the Three R's approach.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the "Three R's" (Relief, Recovery, Reform) organize Roosevelt's approach to ending the Great Depression?

- A** Relief provided immediate help to unemployed (CCC, WPA), Recovery programs restored economic activity (AAA, NRA), and Reform programs fixed underlying problems (FDIC, SEC, Social Security). ✓
- B** FDR used only one approach throughout the New Deal.
- C** The Three R's were unrelated programs.
- D** Roosevelt opposed the Three R's approach.

Correct answer: A. Why: FDR organized the New Deal around Relief (immediate aid to suffering), Recovery (restoring economic growth), and Reform (fixing problems that caused the Depression), creating a comprehensive approach to addressing the crisis at multiple levels.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Relief Programs: CCC and WPA
- Recovery Programs: AAA and NRA
- Reform Programs: Banking and Securities
- Reform Programs: Labor and Social Security
- Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA)

★ **EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Which of the '3 Rs', relief, recovery, or reform, was the most important legacy of the New Deal? Defend your claim with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how the New Deal used relief, recovery, and reform to fight the Depression. Give a specific program for each.

TEACHER DECISION BAND **PROGRESS CHECK** → identify barrier → select support → reteach → recheck → extend

SCAFFOLD FADING Guided → Light → independent on evidence; reintroduce for a new barrier. Required IEP/504 accommodations do not fade unless the authorized team changes them.

STANDARD

US.44

Effects and Controversies of New Deal Policies

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

I CAN

I can analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and FDR's "court packing" attempt.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.43 What were the '3 Rs' of the New Deal?

2

US.43 What was the Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA)?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Name one lasting program created by the New Deal that still exists today.

✓ **ANSWER**

Social Security (or the FDIC, or the SEC), created to protect Americans and prevent future collapse.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

The New Deal built dams, dammed rivers, insured bank deposits, and created Social Security, but critics called Roosevelt a dictator, accused him of socialism, and fought him all the way to the Supreme Court.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Did the New Deal save American capitalism or dangerously expand government power, and why are Americans still arguing about it today?

Economic Effects

- Unemployment fell from 25% (1933) to 14% (1937), though rose again to 19% in 1938.
- Manufacturing output increased 60% between 1933-1937.
- Bank stability was restored through FDIC, farm income doubled, and \$11 billion was invested in infrastructure.
- Government spending increased from 3% to 10% of GDP, fundamentally expanding the federal role in the economy.

SENTENCE FRAME · LANGUAGE SUPPORT (for every learner)

Supporters said the New Deal _____, but critics argued it _____.



Federal Art Project / Works Progress Administration (WPA), c. 1936
[Library of Congress](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Long-term Structural Changes

- Power shifted from states to the federal government.
- Executive branch authority greatly expanded.
- Americans came to expect government would manage the economy.
- A new Democratic coalition of labor, minorities, and urban voters dominated politics for decades.
- Many New Deal agencies and programs—Social Security, FDIC, SEC, TVA—continue operating today.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

In Tennessee, the New Deal's most visible legacy is the TVA, which permanently reshaped the state with flood control, cheap electricity, and public power. The TVA remains a federally owned corporation today, a lasting structural change born from the New Deal that still powers much of the region.



Newman (artist), 1935 [Library of Congress](#)

Charges of Socialism

- Critics argued New Deal programs expanded government control over the economy, redistributed income, and regulated private enterprise—resembling socialism.
- Business leaders claimed policies undermined free enterprise and property rights.
- However, New Deal reforms largely preserved private ownership while increasing regulation and social welfare, not establishing government ownership of industry.

Court-Packing Controversy

- After the Supreme Court struck down the AAA and NRA as unconstitutional, FDR proposed adding up to six new justices for any justice over 70½ who didn't retire.
- He argued the Court was overloaded and blocking needed legislation.
- Critics saw it as threatening judicial independence and separation of powers.
- The plan failed in Congress but damaged FDR's political capital.

Differing Perspectives

- Supporters argued New Deal measures stabilized banks, provided jobs, protected workers, and saved capitalism by reforming it.
- Opponents argued it overreached, expanded federal power dangerously, and threatened individual liberty.
- Most historians credit the New Deal with mitigating suffering and building lasting institutions, while noting WWII mobilization actually ended the Depression.

Key Figures

Huey Long

Louisiana senator; 'Share Our Wealth' (1893-1935)



Uncredited news photographer, 1935
[Library of Congress](#)

- Attacked the New Deal as too friendly to the wealthy
 - Proposed 'Share Our Wealth' to cap fortunes and guarantee incomes
- Became FDR's most dangerous rival before his 1935 assassination

STRATEGY Use Long to show the New Deal was attacked from the LEFT as well as the right - it did not go far enough for some.

Father Charles Coughlin

'Radio Priest' & New Deal critic (1891-1979)



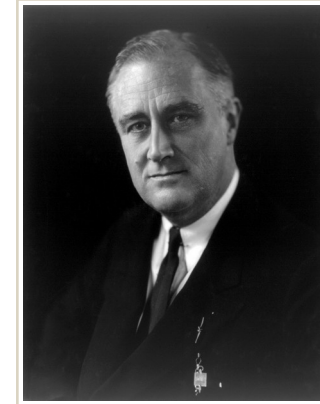
Craine, Detroit, 1933
[Library of Congress](#)

- Reached millions with weekly radio broadcasts
- First backed, then bitterly attacked the New Deal
- Showed the power of radio to build a mass political audience

STRATEGY Pair Coughlin with Long so students see organized popular opposition, not just elite criticism.

Franklin D. Roosevelt

32nd President; defended the New Deal



Elias Goldensky, 1933
[Library of Congress](#)

- Won a landslide re-election in 1936
- Proposed the 1937 'court-packing' plan after the Court struck down programs
- Faced charges of socialism and executive overreach

STRATEGY Use FDR here as the defendant: students weigh the socialism and court-packing charges against him.

Share Our Wealth Program

Close Reading

Senator Huey Long • 1934

"We propose to limit the size of each fortune. No person shall own more than 3 or 4 million dollars. We will guarantee every family in America an annual income of \$2,000 to \$2,500 and a home worth \$5,000. Every child shall have a free education from kindergarten through college. The hours of labor will be limited so as to give the masses more time for recreation."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

Senator Huey Long of Louisiana was one of the most colorful and dangerous politicians in American history — a genuine populist who built a powerful political machine in Louisiana, became a senator in 1932, and by 1934 was threatening FDR's hold on the Democratic left. Long's 'Share Our Wealth' program proposed radical redistribution: cap personal fortunes at \$5 million, limit annual income to \$1 million, and provide every American family with a minimum income, free education, and old-age pensions. He claimed over 7 million members in his Share Our Wealth clubs by 1935. Roosevelt's advisors feared Long could drain enough votes from FDR to elect a Republican in 1936. Long was assassinated in September 1935.

ANALYZE

How did Huey Long's "Share Our Wealth" differ from the New Deal?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Senator Huey Long	1934	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [U.S. Senate Historical Office](#)

Word Wall

Court Packing Plan

say: kort PAK-ing plan

Plan de Empaquetar la Corte

CP

FDR's controversial 1937 proposal to add up to 6 justices to the Supreme Court after it struck down New Deal laws, seen as an attack on judicial independence.

New Deal

say: noo deel

New Deal

ND

FDR's comprehensive programs to provide relief, recovery, and reform during the Great Depression, fundamentally expanding federal government power and establishing the social safety net.

Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)

say: sih-KYOOR-ih-teez and eks-CHAYNJ

Comisión de Valores y Bolsa (SEC)

SA

Federal agency created to regulate the stock market, prevent fraud, and protect investors from the abuses that contributed to the 1929 crash.

Socialism Accusations

say: SOH-shuh-liz-um ak-yoo-ZAY-shunz

Acusaciones de Socialismo

SA

Conservative critics charged that the New Deal was socialist or communist for expanding government power, though FDR argued he was saving capitalism from collapse.

Fair Labor Standards Act (1938)

say: fair LAY-bor STAN-derdz

Ley de Normas Justas de Trabajo (1938)

FL

Established the first federal minimum wage (\$0.25/hour), maximum 44-hour work week (dropping to 40 hours by 1940), overtime pay, and banned child labor in interstate commerce.

Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC)

say: FED-er-ul dee-POZ-it in-SHOOR-uns

Corporación Federal de Seguro de Depósitos (FDIC)

FD

New Deal agency that insures bank deposits up to \$250,000, preventing bank runs by guaranteeing depositors won't lose their savings if banks fail.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Weigh competing arguments
about the New Deal

MODEL PROMPT: Was the New Deal socialism, not-enough, or a rescue of capitalism?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Critics on the right called it socialism; Huey Long said it did too little for the poor; defenders said it SAVED capitalism by reforming it. The same programs drew opposite charges.

THINK ALOUD

Match each critic (Long, socialism critics, FDR) to the argument they made.

→ **Now you try:** *Take a side on whether the New Deal went too far or not far enough, with one piece of evidence.*

Saved or Overreached? — The Great New Deal Debate

Pairs

15 min

RESPONSE CHOICE write it · say & record it · diagram & label it — *all three demonstrate the same learning target.*

YOUR TASK

Read Huey Long's 'Share Our Wealth' program and review the WPA and Social Security posters. Build a two-column chart: ARGUMENTS FOR the New Deal (put people to work, insured banks and deposits, Social Security safety net, lasting structural changes like the TVA) and ARGUMENTS AGAINST (charges of socialism, too much federal power, the court-packing plan, and critics like Long who said it did too little). List at least two per column. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether the New Deal saved capitalism or dangerously expanded government.

DELIVERABLE

Completed for/against chart (2+ per column) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the New Deal.

SUPPORT OPTION · EXTENSION

SUPPORT OPTION: Chart pre-labeled 'For' and 'Against' with a word bank of arguments to sort.
EXTENSION: Write a paragraph explaining why Huey Long attacked the New Deal from the LEFT while business leaders attacked it from the RIGHT, using evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-5/us44-new-deal-effects.pdf](https://cornell-notes.com/unit-5/us44-new-deal-effects.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

What were the main economic effects of New Deal policies on employment, banking, and government spending?

- A** New Deal policies had no measurable economic impact.
- B** The economy worsened under New Deal policies.
- C** Unemployment fell from 25% to 14%, bank runs ended with FDIC, manufacturing increased 60%, and government spending grew from 3% to 10% of GDP.
- D** Only banking was affected by New Deal programs.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What were the main economic effects of New Deal policies on employment, banking, and government spending?

- A** New Deal policies had no measurable economic impact.
- B** The economy worsened under New Deal policies.
- C** Unemployment fell from 25% to 14%, bank runs ended with FDIC, manufacturing increased 60%, and government spending grew from 3% to 10% of GDP.
- D** Only banking was affected by New Deal programs.

Correct answer: C. **Why:** New Deal policies produced measurable economic improvements: reduced unemployment, stabilized banking through FDIC, increased industrial production, doubled farm income, and fundamentally expanded government's economic role, though full recovery required WWII mobilization.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Economic Effects
- Long-term Structural Changes
- Charges of Socialism
- Court-Packing Controversy
- Differing Perspectives

★ **EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Did the New Deal save American capitalism or dangerously expand federal power? Argue your position with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain the main arguments FOR and AGAINST the New Deal. Give at least one specific example of each.

TEACHER DECISION BAND **PROGRESS CHECK** → identify barrier → select support → reteach → recheck → extend

SCAFFOLD FADING Guided → Light → independent on evidence; reintroduce for a new barrier. Required IEP/504 accommodations do not fade unless the authorized team changes them.

Reached — and Left Out

Black Americans

The AAA's crop-reduction payments went to landowners, pushing many Black sharecroppers and tenant farmers off the land, and Social Security (1935) at first excluded farm and domestic workers — jobs held by most Black workers. Yet FDR's informal "Black Cabinet," including Mary McLeod Bethune and Robert Weaver, advised the administration, and Black voters shifted toward the Democratic Party.

Mexican Americans

Amid Depression job competition, "Mexican Repatriation" (about 1929–1936) pressured an estimated 400,000 to more than one million people of Mexican descent — many of them U.S.-born citizens — to leave for Mexico. Mexican and Filipino farmworkers in California often faced lower pay and worse conditions than white "Okie" migrants.

Indigenous Peoples

The Indian Reorganization Act of 1934 (the "Indian New Deal"), led by John Collier, ended the Dawes-era allotment policy, restored some tribal self-government and land, and supported Native culture — a major reversal, though its results were mixed and debated. A CCC Indian Division employed thousands.

History Hack-authored instructional synthesis grounded in the standard historical record — not a primary source. Verified public-domain images and primary sources for these histories are a pending content addition.

Unit 5 Complete

The Great Depression & the New Deal (1929–1941) · from the crash, the Dust Bowl, and Hoovervilles to Hoover's response and FDR's relief, recovery, and reform.

Revisit your unit hook: What caused the Depression, and how far should the government go to rescue its people? You can now answer with evidence — from margin buying and bank failures to the CCC, WPA, TVA, and Social Security.

Next: Unit 6 — World War II & the Rise of Totalitarianism